

BenQ E900WA

Value For Money

The E900WA is a 19-inch widescreen LCD from BenQ. A while back, we tested the BenQ X2200W—a 22-inch LCD monitor, which resembles this monitor in the looks department, at least.

At first glimpse, the designs are pretty identical. The stand is standard plastic without any special treatment or design but it is really flexible in allowing you to tilt the screen backwards and forwards. The screen cannot be rotated in any other direction, though.

The screen performs fairly well even though this is a TN panel. Viewing angles are alright but there is some visible backlight bleeding along the edges of the screen. There is also some wavering interference on the sides of the

screen in certain patterns and the expected banding in TN panels is there towards the darker shades of color is there, but is not too noticeable.

There are speakers built into the screen and a 3.5mm cable is used to connect to it. There is also provision to connect an additional headphone. The volume control is easily accessible by the press of a single button. The speakers aren't great, but they get the job done for some basic casual gaming and music.

There is an Auto Adjustment feature which automatically sets up the monitor for you without having to change the settings manually. Using the menus is simple and the controls are placed on the right of the monitor. The interface itself is very



colourful and user friendly, so pretty much anyone can use it. There are plenty of display modes geared towards different kind of viewing and each of these can be switched to without having to go through deep into the menu.

There is just a VGA connector available with this screen. The biggest missing feature in this monitor is a DVI port which is a must for any LCD screen today—especially one that costs Rs 9,600.

Specifications

19-inch widescreen, 1440 x 900, Contrast Ratio: 700:1, Response time: 5ms.

Contact: Neoteric / eSys
Phone: 1-800-22-0808
E-mail: sales.enquiryin@BenQ.com
Web site: www.benq.co.in
Price: Rs 9,600

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Transcend T.sonic 850

Expensive, But Still Good

The Transcend T.sonic 850 is an upgrade from the T.sonic 840. The styling has a few changes and the controls that were on the side with the 850 have returned to the front of the player. Transcend has also done away with the 840's metal back—which we liked because it gave it a solid robust feel.

An 1.8-inch screen allows you to watch videos and read text. While listening to music, the screen is used to display



the visualisation. The buttons feel good and the controls are really simple to get used to. The earplugs supplied are pretty bad in quality with a cheap feel to them. The player is capable of driving full fledged headphones as well.

The player can be used to view images and movie playback as well, but only one format—MTV—is supported. Conversion software is provided for this purpose. You can simply dump files in to the player, without the need of any syncing software. Books can be read as

well, but only TXT files are supported. Data transfer rates are perfect and the player is able to skip through songs and fast-forward without any effort. There is a protection cover supplied with the player to prevent any fine scratches to the surface.

The player is available in 4 GB and 8 GB versions. We received the white 4 GB version, for testing and is priced at Rs 5,500, which we think is a little overpriced. From a standpoint of a T.sonic 840 user, there is nothing in the 850 that will convince you to move to it. For anyone looking for a decent-value-for-money

media player, the T.sonic 850 fits the slot perfectly.

Specifications

Capacity: 4 GB, Formats supported: MP3, WMA, WAV, MTV Dimensions: 81.5 x 41.5 x 12.7 mm

Contact: Mediaman Infotech Pvt Ltd
Phone: +91-22-23828100 / 8200
E-mail: sales@mediamangroup.com
Web site: www.transcendusa.com
Price: Rs 5,500

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

ZOTAC nForce 790i-Supreme

Costly, And Perhaps Early

NVIDIA's only offerings aren't just the new range of graphics cards, but also motherboard chipsets. The 790i chipset for Intel processors is one of the top models offered today, and the Zotac nForce 790i Supreme is based on it.

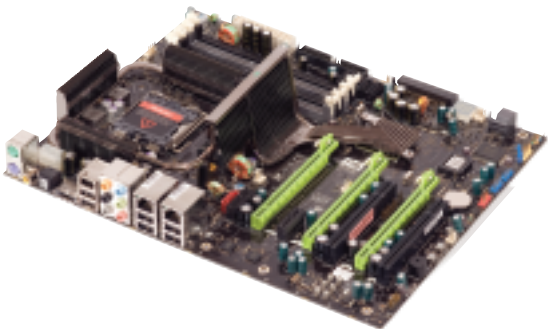
The board design and layout is the same as the stock layout used by NVIDIA. There are no additional cooling enhancements. There are plenty of heat sinks and heat pipes connecting them, but the quality isn't all that great. The big difference in the 790i chipsets is that these are DDR3-only boards. There are four slots for up to 8 GB of memory.

The board supports 3-way SLI. The BIOS is clean and is pretty standard with nothing

out of the way. There are several over clocking features. The HD audio solution is based on Azalia and there is a dual Gigabit LAN built into the board.

In terms of performance, it matches the P35 and X48 chipset motherboards that we tested. Even the hard drive marks matched other motherboards of its class. The drive index for our drive showed 78 MBps but the memory benchmark was a tiny bit higher than the ones on the P35 boards running DDR2 memory. There was a minor 5 to 6 per cent in the memory benchmarks, but it didn't translate to performance in real world benchmarks such as games.

The entire package doesn't come with anything special, other than the usual



cables and back panels. A WiFi kit is also included.

DDR3 is still very expensive to consider and the price of this board doesn't help. At Rs 19,899, it is an extremely expensive proposition for a performance rig, especially with no clear benefits of DDR3 visible at the moment. Users thinking of investing a lot in a long term 3-way SLI rig running on DDR3 memory should go for this.

Specifications

LGA 775 socket, Chipset: nForce

790i Ultra SLI, Upto 1600MHz FSB, Supports 3-way and Quad SLI, 4 DIMM slots for 8GB DDR3 memory, Dual Gigabit LAN

Contact: ZOTAC
Phone: +91-9920675457
E-mail: sales@zotac.com
Web site: www.zotac.com
Price: Rs 19,899

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★
Overall	★★★★

D-Link DSL-2640T

Great Features, Good Value

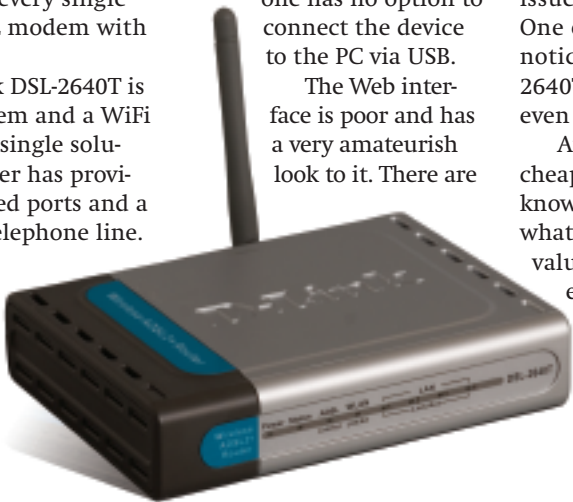
If you can find a telephone line, you've found an ADSL2 connection. Country wide ISPs like BSNL and MTNL provide users with broadband connections and every single one has a DSL modem with them.

The D-Link DSL-2640T is an ADSL modem and a WiFi router in one single solution. The router has provision for 4 wired ports and a port for the telephone line. This is an

802.11g router. The design is the standard design D-Link uses for most of

its ADSL modems. Setting up the router is incredibly simple and the installation CD guides you through the setup. Unlike some of the other D-Link models, this one has no option to connect the device to the PC via USB.

The Web interface is poor and has a very amateurish look to it. There are



plenty of features in the interface though. There is everything from firewalls and port forwarding to parental control built into it.

File transfers on a wired network are fast. A 700 MB file takes around a 100 seconds to copy. There are no visible latency issues with the DSL-2640T. One of the things you notice is that the DSL-2640T gets a little warm even when idle.

At Rs. 3,200, it is cheaper than some well known brands, but you get what you pay for. It is good value for money, considering the number of

features it has. What it doesn't have, is an attractive design so you can keep it on your table for everyone to see. For

a user who has a multiple PCs and a laptop, this ADSL Wireless router makes perfect sense to buy.

Specifications

Built in ADSL, 802.11g Wireless LAN, 4 RJ-45 10/100 Mbps ports, Maximum ADSL speed: ADSL2+ 24 Mbps downstream and 1 Mbps upstream. Dimensions: 142 x 109 x 31 mm, Weight: 239.4 gms

Contact: D-Link India Ltd.
Phone: +91-22-30616666
E-mail: sales@dlink.co.in
Web site: www.dlink.co.in
Price: Rs 3,200

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★